



Great Barrier Reef

Cairns & surrounds, QLD · UNESCO World Heritage Site · Queensland, Australia



The Great Barrier Reef is one of the world's most extraordinary natural environments — and one of the most vulnerable. Please read and follow these guidelines carefully. They exist to protect the reef, its wildlife and the cultural heritage of Traditional Owner communities whose sea Country this has been for tens of thousands of years.

BEFORE YOU GO IN THE WATER

Only enter the water with GBRMPA-permitted operators. Use reef-safe, TGA-approved sunscreen — standard sunscreens contain chemicals that damage coral. Listen to your crew safety briefing before every in-water activity.

DOS AND DON'TS

DO

- ☐ Use reef-safe, TGA-approved sunscreen
- ☐ Wear a wetsuit or stinger suit in season
- ☐ Stay at least 1m from coral and giant clams
- ☐ Stay 3–5m from all free-swimming wildlife
- ☐ Use moorings — never anchor on coral
- ☐ Always use the buddy system when snorkelling
- ☐ Listen to all crew safety briefings
- ☐ Report coral damage or pollution to GBRMPA
- ☐ Choose HSTO-certified tour operators
- ☐ Join the Reef Census citizen science program

DO NOT

- ☐ Touch, stand on or kick any coral
- ☐ Chase, touch or block any marine wildlife
- ☐ Feed fish — it disrupts natural behaviour
- ☐ Take coral, shells or any marine material
- ☐ Discharge rubbish, fuel or plastics overboard
- ☐ Disturb nesting seabirds on reef islands
- ☐ Enter green (preservation) zones
- ☐ Approach whale sharks within 3 metres
- ☐ Approach whales within 300m
- ☐ Buy souvenirs made from coral or reef species

BOATING & VESSEL RULES

Overboard sewage discharge is illegal. Reduce speed near dugongs, turtles and dolphins. Whales: 300m (100m if approaching). Whale sharks: never within 3m.

FORBIDDEN SOUVENIRS

Illegal to take, buy or export coral, protected shells, turtle products or any CITES-listed species item — whether sold commercially or not. If in doubt, do not purchase.

Please retain this document for the duration of your reef visit. For more information visit australia-inbound.com or contact your Orange Journeys representative.